ENGLISH B2 · ADVANCED GRAMMAR

Discourse markers and cohesion

Organise addition, contrast, sequence, reformulation and conclusion with markers whose position and punctuation fit the discourse. The lesson connects form, meaning, register and real editorial decisions rather than treating the pattern as an isolated rule.

THE CENTRAL IDEA

Use discourse markers and cohesion to show the reader how one sentence relates to the developing argument or explanation while preserving the intended meaning and register.

Organise addition, contrast, sequence, reformulation and conclusion with markers whose position and punctuation fit the discourse.

MODEL

The method is efficient; however, it requires careful supervision.

sentence connector + punctuation | coordinating/subordinating linker inside clause structure

6 GUIDED STAGES · 30 LEARNING DECISIONS

This complete guide combines explanation, visual reasoning, practice and feedback. Separate exercise and answer-key editions are also available from the lesson page.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

OUTCOME 1

01

Recognise the main discourse markers and cohesion patterns in authentic contexts.

OUTCOME 2

02

Choose a form that accurately expresses show the reader how one sentence relates to the developing argument or explanation.

OUTCOME 3

03

Avoid errors that change time, agency, emphasis or speaker commitment.

OUTCOME 4

04

Use the structure appropriately in essays, presentations, reports and extended conversation.

Build meaning before form

Organise addition, contrast, sequence, reformulation and conclusion with markers whose position and punctuation fit the discourse.

What discourse markers and cohesion communicates

Organise addition, contrast, sequence, reformulation and conclusion with markers whose position and punctuation fit the discourse.

The central purpose is to show the reader how one sentence relates to the developing argument or explanation. A successful choice therefore preserves the proposition while making the intended relationship, viewpoint or degree of commitment visible to the reader.

The method is efficient; however, it requires careful supervision.	a contrast between two independent propositions
The change reduces cost; moreover, it improves response time.	an additional point that strengthens the argument
The deadline is fixed; in other words, no extension is possible.	a restatement that makes the implication explicit

How the pattern is built

Use this working formula: sentence connector + punctuation | coordinating/subordinating linker inside clause structure. The formula is a decision path: it identifies the trigger, the clause architecture and the element that carries tense or modality.

The model “The method is efficient; however, it requires careful supervision.” shows the complete pattern in context. Rebuild the sentence from meaning to form instead of translating each word independently.

Choice	Structure	Example
Sentence contrast	sentence; however, sentence	The method is efficient; however, it requires careful supervision.
Addition and reinforcement	moreover/furthermore + clause	The change reduces cost; moreover, it improves response time.
Reformulation	in other words/that is + clarification	The deadline is fixed; in other words, no extension is possible.

Choose by meaning, not by surface similarity

Neighbouring structures may contain similar words but perform different jobs. Compare the three reference patterns and name the intended effect before completing the sentence.

A reliable answer explains both why the chosen form works and why a plausible alternative would change the meaning, time relation, information focus or level of certainty.

Meaning	Best route
a contrast between two independent propositions	Sentence contrast
an additional point that strengthens the argument	Addition and reinforcement
a restatement that makes the implication explicit	Reformulation

Register, discourse and editorial control

This grammar is especially useful in essays, presentations, reports and extended conversation. Its value comes from helping the reader process a relationship efficiently, not from making the sentence sound artificially complex.

After editing, check recoverability, natural word order and consistency with the surrounding paragraph. If the marked structure creates ambiguity, return to a fuller or more neutral clause.

Reason through the pattern

The visual map moves from communicative purpose to structural trigger, then to the final clause. It keeps meaning and form visible at the same time so the learner can justify every choice.

01	02	03
sentence connector	punctuation	coordinating/subordinating linker inside clause structure

DECIDE IN THIS ORDER

STEP 1

Decision 1

Identify the communicative purpose before selecting a form: show the reader how one sentence relates to the developing argument or explanation.

STEP 2

Decision 2

Locate the structural trigger and match it to one of the reference patterns.

STEP 3

Decision 3

Check time reference, clause relationships, agency and speaker commitment.

STEP 4

Decision 4

Read the complete sentence in context and confirm that its register suits essays, presentations, reports and extended conversation.

STEP 5

Decision 5

Compare the result with a neutral alternative and keep the marked form only when it adds useful meaning.

Compare forms and meanings

Use the table to justify each structural choice.

Pattern	Form	Model
Sentence contrast	sentence; however, sentence	The method is efficient; however, it requires careful supervision.
Addition and reinforcement	moreover/furthermore + clause	The change reduces cost; moreover, it improves response time.
Reformulation	in other words/that is + clarification	The deadline is fixed; in other words, no extension is possible.

EXAMPLES AT A GLANCE

The method is efficient; however, it requires careful supervision.	a contrast between two independent propositions
The change reduces cost; moreover, it improves response time.	an additional point that strengthens the argument
The deadline is fixed; in other words, no extension is possible.	a restatement that makes the implication explicit

COMMON ERRORS

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not use however as if it were a coordinating conjunction after a comma alone.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not add moreover when the second point merely repeats the first.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not use in other words to introduce unrelated new evidence.

Recognition in context

Choose the sentence whose grammar matches the stated communicative purpose.

A1 · MEANING DECISION 1

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: a contrast between two independent propositions?

OPTIONS The method is efficient; however, it requires careful supervision. · The change reduces cost; moreover, it improves response time. · The deadline is fixed; in other words, no extension is possible.

A2 · MEANING DECISION 2

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: an additional point that strengthens the argument?

OPTIONS The change reduces cost; moreover, it improves response time. · The deadline is fixed; in other words, no extension is possible. · The method is efficient; however, it requires careful supervision.

A3 · MEANING DECISION 3

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: a restatement that makes the implication explicit?

OPTIONS The deadline is fixed; in other words, no extension is possible. · The method is efficient; however, it requires careful supervision. · The change reduces cost; moreover, it improves response time.

A4 · INTERPRETATION 4

What does “The method is efficient; however, it requires careful supervision.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS a contrast between two independent propositions · an additional point that strengthens the argument · a restatement that makes the implication explicit

A5 · INTERPRETATION 5

What does “The change reduces cost; moreover, it improves response time.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS an additional point that strengthens the argument · a restatement that makes the implication explicit · a contrast between two independent propositions

A6 · INTERPRETATION 6

What does “The deadline is fixed; in other words, no extension is possible.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS a restatement that makes the implication explicit · a contrast between two independent propositions · an additional point that strengthens the argument

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Form and function

Identify both the structural family and the meaning carried by each model.

B1 · FORM AND FUNCTION 1

“The method is efficient; however, it requires careful supervision.” uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Sentence contrast / Addition and reinforcement / Reformulation · Gap 2: a contrast between two independent propositions / an additional point that strengthens the argument / a restatement that makes the implication explicit

B2 · FORM AND FUNCTION 2

“The change reduces cost; moreover, it improves response time.” uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Addition and reinforcement / Reformulation / Sentence contrast · Gap 2: an additional point that strengthens the argument / a restatement that makes the implication explicit / a contrast between two independent propositions

B3 · FORM AND FUNCTION 3

“The deadline is fixed; in other words, no extension is possible.” uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Reformulation / Sentence contrast / Addition and reinforcement · Gap 2: a restatement that makes the implication explicit / a contrast between two independent propositions / an additional point that strengthens the argument

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Guided discourse choices

Maintain accurate form and meaning across a connected sequence of decisions.

C1 · EDITORIAL PLANNING

Choose the model that expresses a contrast between two independent propositions: _____. Choose the model that expresses an additional point that strengthens the argument: _____. Choose the model that expresses a restatement that makes the implication explicit: _____. Choose the model built with sentence; however, sentence: _____. Choose the model built with moreover/furthermore + clause: _____. Choose the model built with in other words/that is + clarification: _____.

_____
_____

WORD BANK

Available forms

The change reduces cost; moreover, it improves response time. · The deadline is fixed; in other words, no extension is possible. · The method is efficient; however, it requires careful supervision.

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Open reconstruction

Recover the missing structural trigger without a word bank.

D1 · INDEPENDENT RECONSTRUCTION

The method is efficient; _____, it requires careful supervision. The change reduces cost; _____, it improves response time. The deadline is fixed; _____, no extension is possible. State the full structural pattern for Sentence contrast: _____. State the full structural pattern for Addition and reinforcement: _____.

_____
_____
_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Controlled transformation

Rewrite the neutral source so that it performs the requested advanced function.

E1 · TRANSFORMATION 1

Rewrite “The method is efficient, but it needs supervision.” using the Sentence contrast pattern to express a contrast between two independent propositions.

_____
_____

E2 · TRANSFORMATION 2

Rewrite “The change has two benefits: cost and response time.” using the Addition and reinforcement pattern to express an additional point that strengthens the argument.

_____
_____

E3 · TRANSFORMATION 3

Rewrite “The fixed deadline means extensions are impossible.” using the Reformulation pattern to express a restatement that makes the implication explicit.

_____
_____

E4 · TRANSFORMATION 4

Rewrite “The method is efficient, but it needs supervision.” using the Sentence contrast pattern to express a contrast between two independent propositions.

_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Communicative production

Use the grammar independently in realistic academic, professional and conversational contexts.

F1 · PRODUCTION TASK 1

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Sentence contrast to express a contrast between two independent propositions, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F2 · PRODUCTION TASK 2

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Addition and reinforcement to express an additional point that strengthens the argument, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F3 · PRODUCTION TASK 3

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Reformulation to express a restatement that makes the implication explicit, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

07 · RETRIEVAL

Final self-check

Complete these prompts without reopening the guide.

R1 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: communicative purpose.

_____
_____
_____

R2 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: structural trigger.

_____
_____
_____

R3 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: meaning contrast.

_____
_____
_____

R4 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: register choice.

_____
_____
_____

Recognition in context

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

A1

The method is efficient; however, it requires careful supervision.

Sentence contrast is the best match because a contrast between two independent propositions.

A2

The change reduces cost; moreover, it improves response time.

Addition and reinforcement is the best match because an additional point that strengthens the argument.

A3

The deadline is fixed; in other words, no extension is possible.

Reformulation is the best match because a restatement that makes the implication explicit.

A4

a contrast between two independent propositions

The Sentence contrast pattern communicates a contrast between two independent propositions.

A5

an additional point that strengthens the argument

The Addition and reinforcement pattern communicates an additional point that strengthens the argument.

A6

a restatement that makes the implication explicit

The Reformulation pattern communicates a restatement that makes the implication explicit.

Form and function

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

B1

Sentence contrast / a contrast between two independent propositions

The structure belongs to the Sentence contrast pattern. Its communicative purpose is a contrast between two independent propositions.

B2

Addition and reinforcement / an additional point that strengthens the argument

The structure belongs to the Addition and reinforcement pattern. Its communicative purpose is an additional point that strengthens the argument.

B3

Reformulation / a restatement that makes the implication explicit

The structure belongs to the Reformulation pattern. Its communicative purpose is a restatement that makes the implication explicit.

Guided discourse choices

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

C1

The method is efficient; however, it requires careful supervision.

Sentence contrast: sentence; however, sentence.

C2

The change reduces cost; moreover, it improves response time.

Addition and reinforcement: moreover/furthermore + clause.

C3

The deadline is fixed; in other words, no extension is possible.

Reformulation: in other words/that is + clarification.

C4

The method is efficient; however, it requires careful supervision.

Sentence contrast: sentence; however, sentence.

C5

The change reduces cost; moreover, it improves response time.

Addition and reinforcement: moreover/furthermore + clause.

C6

The deadline is fixed; in other words, no extension is possible.

Reformulation: in other words/that is + clarification.

Open reconstruction

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

D1

however

Sentence contrast requires “however” in this model. sentence; however, sentence.

D2

moreover

Addition and reinforcement requires “moreover” in this model. moreover/furthermore + clause.

D3

in other words

Reformulation requires “in other words” in this model. in other words/that is + clarification.

D4

sentence; however, sentence

Sentence contrast is built as sentence; however, sentence.

D5

moreover/furthermore + clause

Addition and reinforcement is built as moreover/furthermore + clause.

Controlled transformation

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

E1

The method is efficient; however, it requires careful supervision.

sentence; however, sentence. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended sentence contrast effect.

E2

The change reduces cost; moreover, it improves response time.

moreover/furthermore + clause. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended addition and reinforcement effect.

E3

The deadline is fixed; in other words, no extension is possible.

in other words/that is + clarification. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended reformulation effect.

E4

The method is efficient; however, it requires careful supervision.

sentence; however, sentence. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended sentence contrast effect.

Communicative production

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

F1

The method is efficient; however, it requires careful supervision. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses sentence; however, sentence accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F2

The change reduces cost; moreover, it improves response time. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses moreover/furthermore + clause accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F3

The deadline is fixed; in other words, no extension is possible. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses in other words/that is + clarification accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

Diagnose the pattern, not only the score

Use this page to decide what to revisit in the complete guide.

CHECK · TRIGGER OR CONTEXT

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · AUXILIARY OR STRUCTURAL CHOICE

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MAIN VERB OR CLAUSE FORM

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MEANING AND REGISTER

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____